

FOST TRAINING RULE OF THE ROAD TEST DEC 15



This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(F) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

You have just taken over as the Officer of the Watch of a T23 frigate (length 133m). The ship is on coastal passage. It is the forenoon watch, the weather is fine with good visibility. The shipping is moderate.

1. You are confident that your Rule of the Road knowledge is fresh and you are aware that in construing and complying with the rules due regard shall be had for what....**(2b)**
(2)
2. You sight a vessel at GREEN 40, range 3 miles and you are on his port bow. The bearing is steady and you assess there is a risk of collision. IAW the rules what actions are required by you and what should be avoided? **(15)**
(2)
3. A vessel is sighted at RED 50, range 4 miles. The range is closing and the bearing is moving very slowly right. You are 40° on his starboard bow.
 - a. What action is required by the Rules? **(15)**
(1)
 - b. You become concerned with the developing situation. Would a sound signal be appropriate and what should be sounded? **(34d)**
(1)
 - c. When do the Rules allow you to take action to avoid collision? **(17a)**
(1)
 - d. What specifically should be avoided if you decide to manoeuvre by altering course? **(17c)**
(1)
4. You sight a vessel apparently stopped. The vessel is displaying three shapes ball diamond ball in a vertical line. What is it, can you tell if the vessel is making way, and what action should you take? **(27b)**
(1)

5. You sight a large vessel displaying a cylinder where it can best be seen. What does this indicate and what action should you take if you approach this vessel? **(18d/28)** (2)

6. You sight a single vessel displaying two balls in a vertical line. If the vessel is making way, what lights should it display by night? **(27a)** (2)

7. You sight a number of small vessels, exhibiting a shape consisting of two cones with their apexes together in a vertical line. In addition, most are displaying a cone apex upwards. What are these vessels engaged in and how should you pass them? **(26c)** (1)

8. You sight MCMVs displaying the shapes for conducting mine countermeasures operations. What action should they take when approaching a helicopter in the dip? **(ATP1F)** (1)

Despite the fine start, you encounter a bank of fog ahead.

9. When should you commence making fog signals and what should they be? **(35/35a)** (2)

10. You hear a sound signal consisting of two prolonged blasts, followed shortly afterwards by four short blasts. What precisely does these sound signals indicate? **(35b/k)** (2)

11. a. The lookout reports hearing a sound signal consisting of one short, one prolonged and one short sounded in succession. What precisely does this signify? **(35g)** (1)

b. As you approach the vessel making the previous sound signal, what other signal would you expect to hear and at what interval? **(35g)** (1)

12. **You detect a vessel on radar at GREEN 60, range 5 miles.** What factors should all vessels consider when determining a safe speed if fitted with an operational radar? **(6b)** (6)

13. Careful plotting shows that a risk of collision exists. How should you manoeuvre if there are no immediate navigational constraints? **(19d)** (1)

14. Rule 8 also covers action to avoid collision but under what conditions of visibility does this rule apply. (1)

The light is fading but the good news is that visibility is rapidly improving and the vessel previously detected by radar can now be seen.

15. You notice this vessel's unusual form and think it might be a WIG craft. How is a WIG craft defined? **(3)** (1)

16. When must navigation lights be exhibited? What restrictions apply to other lights? **(20b)** (2)

17. You sight a vessel displaying three all-round red lights in a vertical line, in addition to her normal navigation lights. What is this? **(28)** (1)

18. You sight a vessel displaying two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and the lower white, in addition to sidelights and stern light. What is this? **(26c)** (1)

19. a. You sight a vessel ahead showing two additional masthead lights on her foremast in addition to her normal navigation lights. What specifically does this indicate? **(24a)** (1)

b. Describe any additional light you would expect to see if you approached this vessel from astern? (Include arcs of visibility.) **(24a)** (1)

20. You sight a vessel displaying three all-round lights in a vertical line, the highest and lowest red and the middle light white. In addition, you identify a single white light in the fore part of the vessel. What types of operation could this vessel be engaged in and what can you conclude if these are the only lights? **(27b)** (1)

21. You sight two MCMVs engaged in mine clearance exercises. What lights should the vessels be displaying in addition to their normal navigation lights and how far off should you pass? **(27f)**

(2)

22. What lights may a vessel at anchor use in addition to her all-round anchor lights? (These lights shall be displayed in vessels exceeding 100 metres in length.) **(30c)**

(1)

Total Marks 40

FOST TRAINING ROR TEST – DEC 15 - ANSWERS

1. **Rule 2b.** ...shall be had to all dangers of navigation and collision and to any special circumstances, including the limitations of the vessels involved, which may make a departure from these Rules necessary to avoid immediate danger.
2. **Rule 15.** ...the vessel which has the other on her starboard side shall keep out of the way (Sound one short blast and alter course to starboard.)
3.
 - a. **Rule 15.** When two power-driven vessels are crossing so as to involve a risk of collision, the vessel which has the other on her own starboard side shall keep out of the way and shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid crossing ahead of the other vessel. (Stand on but monitor the give-way vessel.)
 - b. **Rule 34d.** When vessels in sight of one another are approaching each other and from any cause either vessel fails to understand the intentions or actions of the other, or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blasts on the whistle.
 - c. **Rule 17a.** The latter vessel may, however, take action to avoid collision by her manoeuvre alone, as soon as it becomes apparent to her that the vessel required to keep out of the way is not taking appropriate action in compliance with these Rules.
 - d. **Rule 17c.** A power-driven vessel which takes action in a crossing situation in accordance with sub-paragraph (a)(ii) of this Rule to avoid collision with another power-driven vessel shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, not alter course to port for a vessel on her own port side.
4. **Rule 27b.** Vessel is “restricted in her ability to manoeuvre”. The vessel’s movement can only be determined by bow wave/wake (if present) and you should keep well clear.
5. **Rule 28.** A vessel constrained by her draught may, in addition to the lights prescribed for a power-driven vessel exhibit a cylinder where it can best be seen. **Rule 18d** A power-driven vessel underway shall if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid impeding the safe passage of a vessel constrained by her draught, exhibiting the signals in Rule 28.
6. **Rule 27a** The vessel is “not under command”. At night she should display two all-round red lights (in a vertical line) plus side lights and sternlight. (Masthead lights should be extinguished.)
7. **Rule 26c.** A vessel when engaged in fishing, other than trawling, shall exhibit a shape consisting of two cones with apexes together in a vertical line one above the other. When there is outlying gear extending more than 150m horizontally from the vessel, a cone apex upwards in the direction of the gear. Pass more than 150 m on the side of the outlying gear.
8. **ATP1F.** A helicopter in the dip is considered as a ship not under command and no vessels should approach within 500 yards.
9. As you approach the bank of fog. **Rule 35.** In or near an area of restricted visibility, whether by day or night, the signals prescribed in this Rule shall be used. **Rule 35a.** A power-driven vessel making way through the water shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes one prolonged blast.
10. **Rule 35b/k.** A power-driven vessel underway but stopped which also sounds an identity signal indicating a pilot vessel when engaged on pilotage duty.
11.
 - a. **Rule 35g.** A vessel at anchor may in addition sound three blasts in succession, namely one short, one prolonged and one short blast, to give warning of her position and of the possibility of collision to an approaching vessel.

b. **Rule 35g.** A vessel at anchor shall at intervals of not more than one minute ring the bell rapidly for about 5 seconds. (In a vessel of 100 metres or more in length the bell shall be sounded in the forepart of the vessel and immediately after the ringing of the bell the gong shall be sounded rapidly for about 5 seconds in the after part of the vessel.)

12. **Rule 6b.** Safe speed, additionally by vessels with operational radar;
(i) the characteristics, efficiency and limitations of the radar equipment;
(ii) any constraints imposed by the radar range scale in use;
(iii) the effect on radar detection of the sea state, weather and other sources of interference;
(iv) the possibility that small vessels, ice and other floating objects, may not be detected by radar at an adequate range;
(v) the number, location and movement of vessels detected by radar;
(vi) the more exact assessment of the visibility that may be possible when radar is used to determine the range of vessels or other objects in the vicinity.

13. **Rule 19d.** She shall take avoiding action in ample time, provided that when such action consists of an alteration of course, so far as possible an alteration of course to port for a vessel forward of the beam other than for a vessel being overtaken. (Alter course to starboard as a vessel being overtaken in this relative position would not create a risk of collision.)

14. **Rule 4.** Rules in this part apply in any condition of visibility

15. **Rule 3.** The Term “Wing in Ground (WIG) craft” means a multi modal craft, which, in its main mode, flies in close proximity to the surface by utilizing surface-effect action.

16. **Rule 20b.** The Rules concerning lights must be complied with from sunset to sunrise, and during such time no other lights shall be exhibited, except such lights as cannot be mistaken for the lights specified in these Rules or do not impair their visibility or distinctive character, or interfere with the keeping of a proper look-out.

17. **Rule 28.** A power-driven vessel constrained by her draught.

18. **Rule 26c.** A vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling, when making way through the water.

19. a. **Rule 24a.** A power-driven vessel when towing ...instead of the light prescribed in Rule 23, three masthead lights in a vertical line. Length of tow, measured from the stern of the towing vessel to the after end exceeds 200 metres.

b. **Rule 24a.** A power-driven vessel when towing shall exhibit: a towing light in a vertical line above the sternlight. In addition a vessel or object being towed shall exhibit sidelights and a sternlight (or lights for an inconspicuous partly submerged vessel or object). Yellow light having the same characteristics as the sternlight.

20. **Rule 27b.** A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, except a vessel engaged in mineclearance operations, shall exhibit three all-round lights in a vertical line where they can best be seen. The highest and lowest of these lights shall be red and the middle light shall be white. When at anchor, in addition, the light(s) prescribed in Rule 30. Could be laying, servicing or picking up a navigation mark, submarine cable or pipeline, or surveying but unlikely to be dredging or carrying out underwater operations due to the anchor light. (See Rule 27d)

21. **Rule 27f.** A vessel engaged in mine clearance operations shall in addition to the lights prescribed for a power-driven vessel in Rule 23 or to the lights or shapes prescribed for a vessel at anchor in Rule 30 as appropriate, exhibit three all-round green lights. One of these lights shall be exhibited near the foremast head and one at each end of the fore yard.

22. **Rule 30c.** *A vessel at anchor may, and a vessel of 100 metres and more in length shall, also use the available working or equivalent lights to illuminate her decks.*

Total 40